

Home Comfort - Two-Page Operating Benchmark

Reliance Home Comfort and Enercare | Source report dated July 18, 2026

SUBVERTICAL THESIS

Home Comfort is one installed-residential archetype: provider-owned or supported water heaters and HVAC equipment, plus protection plans and one-time service. A dense installed base converts essential household needs into recurring monthly billing. Pricing, premium-equipment mix, and cross-sell drive growth; low-touch water heaters support high margins. Equipment exchanges, removal, and reinstallation still consume sustaining capital. Enercare anchors the benchmark with cleaner segment disclosure; Reliance widens the range through its broader, less separable mix.

METRIC	BENCHMARK RANGE	WHY THE ASSERTION MAKES SENSE	STRONGEST SUPPORT / CAVEAT
Revenue growth	Core low / central / high: 3% / 5% / 7%; broader observed range: 3%-8%.	Mature installed bases grow mainly through price, HVAC and premium-unit mix, cross-sell, modest net units, and occasional M&A; acquisitions are not organic growth.	Enercare revenue rose 6% in 9M 2018 while units rose only 0.6% and monthly rent increased from C\$24.35 to C\$25.50. Reliance customer growth was low-single-digit annually before U.S. tuck-ins. Confidence: Medium - strong Enercare history, limited current standalone bridges.
EBITDA margin	Core low / central / high: 48% / 53% / 56%; broader observed range: 43%-56%.	Monthly revenue on installed, low-touch water heaters creates high recurring gross margin; technicians, dispatch, support, and transactional services dilute it.	Enercare disclosed C\$201.4 million EBITDA on C\$359.8 million 9M 2018 revenue, about 56%, with contracted revenue near 92%. Reliance has no standalone margin and a broader mix. Confidence: Medium - Enercare is disclosed; Reliance's range is low-confidence and triangulated.
Maintenance capex / revenue	Core low / central / high: 10% / 12% / 14%; broader observed range: 9%-15%.	Providers replace owned end-of-life units, including removal and reinstallation, to preserve billable addresses. Water heaters and plans lower intensity; HVAC raises it.	Enercare exchanged 33.6 thousand assets in 9M 2018, 2.9% of opening units, and found used heaters uneconomic to redeploy. Reliance cites 14-16-year lives and included replacement. Confidence: Medium - replacement-cycle derived; Reliance-specific capex is low-confidence.
Post-maintenance capex conversion	Core low / central / high: 73% / 78% / 82%; broader observed range: 68%-84%.	Recurring billing creates strong EBITDA, but exchanges prevent software-like conversion. This measure excludes interest, taxes, working capital, lease principal, and growth capex.	The 78% center follows 53% EBITDA margin and 12% maintenance capex. Enercare additions, attrition, and exchanges show that some new installation spend merely preserves revenue. Confidence: Medium - direct arithmetic, derived capex; Reliance is low-confidence.
Initial contract tenor	Low: at-will or legacy cohorts; central: 7-10 years; high: useful-life or roughly 15-year-style economics. Broader range spans mixed legacy at-will to useful-life forms.	Newer rentals use minimum-term, buyout, or useful-life structures to recover capital; legacy Ontario water-heater cohorts can be cancellable or non-term.	Reliance cites 7-10-year minimums, 10 years then monthly, and separate non-term and 84-month forms. Enercare historically split heaters between non-buyout and buyout contracts. Confidence: Medium - forms are observable; current cohort mix is not.
Effective customer tenure	Core low / central / high: 12 / 18 / 25 years; broader observed range: 10-25 years.	Address-level continuity, residential inertia, home-sale transfer, and convenient replacement can carry revenue beyond both legal term and the first asset.	Enercare rental attrition was 1.9% over 9M 2018; Reliance continues monthly after initial terms. Short-period attrition is not mechanically converted into customer life. Confidence: Medium - same-household tenure is inferred and differs from equipment life.
Utilization exposure	Low / central / high: Low / Low-Moderate / Moderate; broader range: Low to Moderate.	Asset utilization is largely binary: installed on a paying account or not. Household usage intensity does not normally change fixed rent. The more important exposure is seasonal technician, installer, and dispatch capacity.	Company reporting emphasizes units, contracts, attrition, exchanges, service response, and installed accounts rather than consumption or runtime. Confidence: High - contract mechanics and operating KPIs make the qualitative classification clear.
New-unit or customer payback	Core low / central / high: 6.5 / 8 / 10 years; broader observed range: 6-11 years.	Fully burdened payback includes equipment, installation, acquisition, service, repair, and replacement reserve. Basic heaters repay slower; HVAC and premium units repay faster.	Reliance showed C\$1,000-C\$5,500 installed cost and C\$20-C\$100+ monthly rent. Enercare said HVAC rentals earned three to five times traditional heater revenue. Confidence: Medium - triangulated; direct unit contribution is undisclosed.
B2B vs B2C	Low / central: Predominantly B2C; high: B2B contract with residential end users. Broader range: predominantly B2C to mixed edge cases.	Households are the economic center, although builders, property managers, and small commercial channels may originate or intermediate accounts.	Enercare disclosed that about 95% of its rental portfolio consisted of residential water heaters. Reliance's owner and consumer materials identify homeowners as the primary customer base. Confidence: High - product mix and customer positioning are explicit.

HOW TO READ THE UNIVERSE

Both companies monetize essential household infrastructure through installed assets and service. Rentals and protection plans are recurring; outright HVAC sales and one-time work are distinct. Retention reflects convenience and address continuity, but also historical switching friction, so customer life is not enforceable term. Returns depend on dense field service, recovery of installation cost, and continued billing or replacement after the first unit ages out.

Reliance Home Comfort

What it does. Reliance Comfort Limited Partnership serves more than 2 million customers, mainly in Ontario, with reported western Canadian, Georgia, and Florida operations. It rents and sells water heaters and HVAC and offers water purification, plumbing, electrical, smart-home, and protection plans. It solves urgent hot-water, heating, and cooling needs without upfront purchase or surprise repair risk. The benchmark isolates rentals and plans from one-time work.

Economic model. The core unit is an installed asset at a residential address; plans and one-time jobs are separate units. Reliance funds equipment and installation, retains ownership, bills monthly, provides repair and replacement, and operates technicians, dispatch, and call centers. Essentiality, installation, budget smoothing, transfers, and replacement convenience support retention; moves, buyouts, switching, poor service, repricing, purchase, and technology migration drive churn. Used hardware has limited redeployment value, so the address relationship is the key residual asset.

Evidence bridge. Acquired in 2017 at about C\$4.6 billion enterprise value, Reliance grew from 1.8 million customers to 2.1 million by end-2023 and made two U.S. acquisitions in 2025. Terms show 7-10-year minimums, 14-16-year heater lives, included installation, repair and replacement, and C\$20-C\$100+ monthly rent. Current standalone financial, churn, and growth bridges are unavailable, making several company metrics low-confidence.

Enercare

What it does. Enercare is an Ontario-centric platform serving about 1.1 million customers. The relevant business is Home Services, excluding former Service Experts and submetering. It rents water heaters, HVAC, and water-treatment equipment, sells plans, and performs equipment sales and service, offering predictable cost and outsourced continuity for essential systems. Brookfield acquired it in 2018; the clean segment base is 2017 and 9M 2018.

Economic model. The core unit is an installed rental unit, about 95% residential water heaters historically; plans and one-time HVAC jobs are separate. Rentals were 73% of 2017 revenue and plans 20%. Heaters require little scheduled maintenance; HVAC and plans use more field labor. Ownership, installation, response, and buyout or useful-life terms support retention; moves, buyouts, switching, repricing, and poor service cause churn. Equipment is replaced rather than redeployed, making exchanges sustaining capital and allowing relationships to continue through replacement.

Evidence bridge. In 9M 2018, contracted revenue was C\$332.0 million of C\$359.8 million total, EBITDA margin was 56%, units grew 0.6%, and 33.6 thousand assets were exchanged. Rental attrition was 1.9% versus 9.3% for plans. HVAC rentals generated three to five times heater revenue. Current post-privatization segment data are unavailable.

KEY DILIGENCE QUESTIONS

Separate recurring rentals and plans from one-time sales, service, and acquisition-led growth. | Obtain current product mix, gross additions, attrition, exchange volume, and direct service cost by cohort. | Test how much installation spending labeled as growth merely replaces churn and is economically sustaining. | Distinguish legal protection from residential inertia and historical switching friction. | Keep address-level customer tenure separate from the life of any individual heater or HVAC unit.

Point-of-Use Water - Two-Page Operating Benchmark

AquaVenture Holdings / Quench and Primo Water | Source report dated July 18, 2026

SUBVERTICAL THESIS

The core archetype is Quench's workplace point-of-use model: company-owned filtration dispensers installed for fixed recurring fees including filters, sanitation, maintenance, and support. Primo is a mixed reference because filings combine filtration with refill and the offer spans homes and businesses. The benchmark therefore anchors on Quench, not a simple average. Recurring billing and route density support margins, but technicians and owned equipment add physical intensity. Legal terms can be short; durability comes from installation, service continuity, and switching effort.

METRIC	BENCHMARK RANGE	WHY THE ASSERTION MAKES SENSE	STRONGEST SUPPORT / CAVEAT
Revenue growth	Core low / central / high: 4% / 8% / 12%; broader observed range: 1%-18%.	New placements, added units, price, retention, and acquisitions drive growth, not water throughput. Office health constrains Quench; mixed channels add refill effects.	Quench grew 45.4% in 2019, with 13.6% organic growth. Primo's combined Refill/Filtration channel grew 18.2% in 2023, but filtration-only growth was undisclosed. Confidence: Medium - Quench's anchor is strong but dated; Primo is mixed.
EBITDA margin	Core low / central / high: 24% / 28% / 31%; broader observed range: 12%-31%.	Monthly fees create recurring contribution; technicians, travel, filters, sanitation, repairs, and mix consume margin. Dense workplace routes should outperform fragmented home/business service.	Quench reported \$32.4 million EBITDA on \$115.2 million 2019 revenue, a 28.1% margin. Primo's 12%-24% filtration range is inferred. Confidence: Medium - Quench is reported; Primo is low-confidence.
Maintenance capex / revenue	Core low / central / high: 10% / 13% / 17%; broader observed range: 5%-17%.	Sustaining capital includes replacement systems, returned-unit refurbishment, service vehicles, removal, and reinstallation. Filters are operating cost.	Quench owns about 160,000 rental units. Primo disclosed \$235.0 million net customer equipment with 2-15-year lives, but it includes refill and other assets. Confidence: Low - filtration-specific sustaining capex is undisclosed.
Post-maintenance capex conversion	Core low / central / high: 30% / 54% / 68%; broader observed range: 35%-71%.	Recurring fees support EBITDA, but replacement and service assets absorb cash. This metric is not full free cash flow.	The 54% center uses Quench's 28% margin and 13% capex estimate. Primo's 56% case uses inferred 18% margin and 8% capex. Confidence: Low - capex and Primo EBITDA are derived.
Initial contract tenor	Core low / central / high: 1 month / 1-12 months / 36 months; broader range: one-month rolling to multiyear.	Flexible terms reduce sales friction; some enterprise accounts run longer. Durability relies more on operating stickiness than legal lock-in.	Quench describes primarily month-to-month rental. Primo permits cancellation without penalty after rescission, effective after the next full billing period. Confidence: Medium - terms are direct; account mix is not.
Effective customer tenure	Core low / central / high: 3 / 6 / 9 years; broader observed range: 2-9 years.	Plumbing, service, billing, and multi-unit relationships extend life; office closure, downsizing, hybrid work, easy cancellation, and substitutes shorten it.	Quench averaged about 2.9 units per customer. Primo's rolling cancellation supports a lower 4-year company center. Confidence: Medium core; churn is undisclosed and Primo is low-confidence.
Utilization exposure	Low: low customer-usage / moderate asset; central: moderate overall; high: moderate-high. Broader range: low-to-moderate customer usage and moderate asset/service capacity.	A lightly used contracted machine still earns; a returned unit does not until redeployed. Route density and technician productivity govern service economics.	Quench uses fixed pricing and 500+ technicians, with office-occupancy exposure. Primo diversifies office risk but can be harder to densify. Confidence: Medium - churn, idle fleet, and route KPIs are unavailable.
New-unit or customer payback	Core equipment low / central / high: 1.8 / 2.7 / 3.8 years; core CAC: 0.6 / 1.0 / 1.5 years. Broader equipment range: 1.5-3.8 years; broader CAC range: 0.8-2.0 years.	Equipment payback uses installed cost and contribution after service and sustaining reserve. CAC payback is shorter because one account can support multiple machines.	Quench had 160,000 units and 55,000-plus customers, about 2.9 units per account. Primo plans start at \$27.99 monthly; installed cost is undisclosed. Confidence: Low - both paybacks are derived.
B2B vs B2C	Core low / central: Predominantly B2B; high: almost entirely workplace B2B. Broader range: predominantly B2B to mixed B2B/B2C.	Workplace customers support density but add procurement complexity. Mixed home/business models broaden the funnel while increasing fragmentation and weakening contractual durability.	Quench is explicitly B2B and directs residential users elsewhere. Primo markets to homes, offices, schools, healthcare, hospitality, and manufacturing. Confidence: High core; Primo's exact mix is undisclosed.

HOW TO READ THE UNIVERSE

Point-of-use water replaces bottle logistics with filtration connected to a site's supply. The core unit is a contracted machine; CAC and tenure sit at the account because one customer may support several systems. Providers fund equipment and installation, then filter, sanitize, repair, recover, refurbish, and redeploy. Draw matters less than contract status. The strategic divide is dense workplace B2B versus mixed platforms whose filtration economics are obscured by refill, delivery, retail, and household channels.

AquaVenture Holdings / Quench

What it does. The relevant AquaVenture operation is Quench, excluding Seven Seas Water and desalination. Quench USA, Inc., now a Culligan subsidiary, installs company-owned filtration dispensers for institutional and commercial workplaces in the U.S. and Canada. Fixed-fee plumbed filtration replaces bottle storage, handling, and delivery.

Economic model. The core unit is a machine; CAC and tenure sit at the customer location. Monthly rent includes maintenance and filters; installation may be separate. Multiple machines spread account setup cost. More than 500 technicians install, inspect, sanitize, change filters, and repair, making route density central. Working equipment, included service, predictable bills, and re-plumbing support retention; office closure, relocation, downsizing, hybrid work, rebids, and poor service cause churn. Returns require recovery, refurbishment, and reinstallation before earning again.

Evidence bridge. FY2019 is the last standalone period. Quench had about 160,000 units and 55,000-plus customers, or 2.9 units per account, with \$115.2 million revenue, \$32.4 million adjusted EBITDA, 13.6% organic growth, and six acquisitions. Current materials describe mainly month-to-month rental and included service. Current churn, replacement cycles, installed cost, unit contribution, and capex are unavailable, making capex and payback low-confidence.

Primo Water

What it does. Primo Water's installed filtration offer now sits inside Primo Brands after the November 2024 transaction. It places company-owned carbon or reverse-osmosis systems in homes and businesses, with floor, countertop, and under-sink formats from \$27.99 monthly. It solves taste and convenience needs without bottle logistics or self-managed maintenance. The benchmark excludes delivery, refill, exchange, dispenser sales, and unrelated products where possible.

Economic model. The core unit is a filtration system; the account governs CAC and cross-sell. Primo owns, installs, leases, maintains, filters, sanitizes, repairs, bills, and sometimes monitors devices. Rolling cancellation lowers sales friction but makes retention depend on convenience, service, price, moves, and cross-sell. Home/business reach reduces office concentration but fragments routes and creates internal purchase, refill, exchange, and delivery substitutes. Cancelled equipment must be recovered and redeployed.

Evidence bridge. FY2023 combined Refill/Filtration revenue was \$226.9 million versus \$192.0 million, so filtration growth is not separable. Customer equipment had \$235.0 million net book value and 2-15-year lives but included many non-filtration assets. Cancellation is flexible. Filtration-only revenue, units, customers, churn, EBITDA, service cost, and capex are unavailable; Primo margin, capex, conversion, tenure, and payback are low-confidence.

KEY DILIGENCE QUESTIONS

Obtain filtration-only revenue, installed units, churn, net retention, margin, service cost, and sustaining capex. | Separate organic placements and price from tuck-in acquisitions at Quench and refill-driven growth at Primo. | Measure returned-unit recovery, refurbishment, redeployment, and scrap rates by product family. | Track office occupancy, customer downsizing, route density, and technician productivity by geography. | Keep equipment payback distinct from account-level CAC payback and include direct service plus maintenance reserves.

Submetering Operating Benchmark

Two-page benchmark brief | Analysis date: July 18, 2026 | Energy Assets, ista, Techem, Smart Metering Systems, Calisen, and CARMA

SUBVERTICAL THESIS Submetering contains two different core cash models. Building submetering and billing platforms such as ista and Techem install relatively low-cost devices and monetize recurring billing, data, and compliance workflows; CARMA is a lower-disclosure reference. Meter-asset owners such as Calisen and Smart Metering Systems finance larger utility meters and earn rental and data income over long asset lives. Energy Assets is a mixed metering, data, network, and installation platform. The first model has mid-single-digit growth, high-40s EBITDA margins, moderate reinvestment, and strong conversion. The second can report higher EBITDA, but replacement capital and longer payback materially reduce its cash economics.			
METRIC	BENCHMARK RANGE	WHY THE ASSERTION MAKES SENSE	STRONGEST SUPPORT / CAVEAT
Revenue growth	Subvertical reference: 4% / 6% / 9% low-central-high; broader observed range 3%-12%.	Building platforms grow through indexation, digital refresh, penetration, and data upsell. Meter-asset growth can accelerate with funded rollout, but acquisitions and rollout effects are not normalized organic growth.	ista grew sales about 5.2% in 2025; Techem submetering rose from EUR933.5 million to EUR1,041.5 million. Calisen growth included installation and acquisition; SMS FY2022 ILARR grew 13%. Confidence: Medium
EBITDA margin	Subvertical reference: 33% / 47% / 72%; broader observed range 18%-76%.	Dense billing/data estates have low marginal cost. Asset owners look richer because depreciation and replacement capital sit below EBITDA; service-led and mixed platforms sit lower.	Techem reported EUR557 million EBITDA on EUR1.17 billion 2025 revenue; ista evidence supports 40%+. Calisen reported 74.1% in 2023; SMS reported about 47.1% in FY2022. Confidence: Medium
Maintenance capex / revenue	Subvertical reference: 8% / 12% / 35%; broader observed range 6%-45%.	Building platforms replace cheaper devices, batteries, communications, and IT. Utility-facing owners must replace expensive funded meter estates, making asset intensity the key structural divide.	ista reported EUR260 million total 2025 investment. Calisen disclosed GBP355.5 million 2023 capex, GBP219 per smart meter, and GBP144.8 million meter depreciation; clean sustaining splits are unavailable. Confidence: Medium-Low
Post-maintenance capex conversion	Subvertical reference: 61% / 78% / 82%; broader observed range 24%-87%.	Billing/data platforms convert well after device refresh. Asset owners reserve much more EBITDA for replacement, so high reported margins can yield only roughly 50% conversion.	Derived as (EBITDA - maintenance capex) / EBITDA. Central company cases: ista 78%, Techem 82%, SMS 47%, Calisen 51%. This is not full free-cash-flow conversion. Confidence: Medium-Low because sustaining capex is derived
Initial contract tenor	Subvertical reference: 5 / 7 / 8 years; broader observed range month-to-month to 10 years.	Building awards need term to amortize installation. Utility-meter economics may rely on supplier frameworks and removal compensation, so legal form can be far shorter than asset life.	CARMA has long-term, inflation-protected contracts; ista and Techem publish no standard term. Calisen treats retailer orders as month-to-month although income can survive supplier switching. Confidence: Low-Medium
Effective customer tenure	Subvertical reference: 8 / 14 / 18 years; broader observed range 5-20 years.	Installation, billing history, data migration, and low switching salience extend building tenure. Utility meters can keep earning across supplier changes until physical removal.	ista manages 45 million-plus devices; Techem has roughly 62-70 million. Calisen models arrangements around 15 years and reviewed smart-meter lives at 10-20 years. Confidence: Medium
Utilization exposure	Subvertical reference: Low / Low-Moderate / Moderate; broader observed range Low-High.	Installed meters normally earn regardless of daily consumption. Exposure rises when installation teams, field service, and funded rollout pipelines must remain productive or meters are removed.	ista, Techem, and CARMA monetize installed units and billing. SMS and Calisen also depend on installation pace and supplier programs, although deployed estates remain sticky. Confidence: Medium
New-unit / customer payback	Subvertical reference: 3.0 / 4.5 / 6.5 years; broader observed range 2.0-8.5 years.	Cheaper suite devices plus billing/data yield roughly three-to-five-year payback. Funded utility meters pair higher installed cost with modest annual rent, extending payback.	Calisen disclosed GBP219 capex per meter and GBP23.8 ARPM. SMS expected 2.17 million pipeline meters to add about GBP50 million ILARR, or roughly GBP23 annually each. Confidence: Medium-Low
B2B vs B2C	Subvertical reference: B2B contract with residential end users / B2B contract with residential end users / predominantly B2B.	Owners and managers buy building submetering while residents consume and may receive bills. Suppliers procure funded utility meters; households are users, not core customers.	ista has 460,000-plus customers against 14 million-plus units; Techem and CARMA market to buildings. SMS and Calisen contract with energy suppliers and retailers. Confidence: High

Submetering Operating Benchmark

Two-page benchmark brief | Analysis date: July 18, 2026 | Energy Assets, ista, Techem, Smart Metering Systems, Calisen, and CARMA

HOW TO READ THE UNIVERSE

The six companies span three categories: core building submetering and billing, capital-heavy meter-asset ownership, and a mixed metering/data/network platform. The profiles below use the unit that drives revenue and highlight why similar recurring-revenue labels conceal different field-service, replacement-capital, and contract economics.

Energy Assets What it does. UK metering-and-data provider inside a wider network construction, ownership, water, fibre, and utility-services platform; customers need compliant metering, data, and field service. Economic model. Unit: installed asset with attached data/service. Revenue mixes recurring fees with installation and maintenance. Integrated workflows aid retention; project exposure and segment contamination weaken comparability. Capital supports meters, communications, IT, and vehicles. Evidence bridge. More than 1.5 million managed assets. Clean segment revenue, EBITDA, capex, churn, and terms are unavailable; central 5% growth, 23% EBITDA, and 9% maintenance capex are Low-confidence inferences.	ista What it does. European platform installing apartment meters and allocators, then providing recurring consumption allocation, billing, data, and sustainability workflows to owners and managers. Economic model. Unit: managed dwelling/device footprint. Regulation-shaped demand and dense estates support margin; access, hardware, resident communication, and data migration deter switching. Capital refreshes devices, batteries, communications, and digital infrastructure. Evidence bridge. 45 million-plus devices, 14 million-plus units, 460,000-plus customers, EUR1,279 million 2025 sales, and EUR260 million investment. Central: 6% growth, 45% EBITDA, 10% maintenance capex, 14-year tenure, four-year payback.	Techem What it does. European provider installing apartment devices and monetizing recurring heating/water allocation, billing, data, and digital building services for owners and managers. Economic model. Unit: serviced dwelling/device set. Regulation-shaped demand, radio infrastructure, and embedded billing deter switching; field service and procurement remain costs. The benchmark excludes energy contracting. Evidence bridge. 13 million-plus dwellings, 62-70 million devices; 2025 submetering revenue EUR1,041.5 million and group EBITDA EUR557 million. Central: 6% growth, 49% EBITDA, 9% maintenance capex, 15-year tenure, 3.5-year payback.
Smart Metering Systems What it does. UK platform funding, installing, and managing supplier-facing smart meters for recurring rent and data income; batteries and EV-charging are excluded. Economic model. Unit: owned contracted meter. Ownership and workflow integration support tenure; rollout and supplier procurement drive growth and service utilization. Hardware-plus-installation makes replacement capital heavy. Evidence bridge. Combined group: 6 million-plus meters in 2025. Clean FY2022 base: 2.1 million meters, GBP97.1 million ILARR, GBP63.8 million EBITDA on GBP135.5 million revenue. Central 5.5-year payback; sustaining capex is Medium-Low confidence.	Calisen What it does. UK asset owner funding meters for energy retailers; the benchmark centers on MAP Services and excludes EV charging, heat pumps, and other transition activities. Economic model. Unit: owned revenue-generating meter. Policy drives installs; charges can survive supplier switching. Month-to-month legal orders contrast with 10-20-year economics. High EBITDA requires heavy replacement capital. Evidence bridge. 2023: 15.2 million meters, GBP293.9 million MAP revenue, GBP265.4 million EBITDA, GBP355.5 million capex, GBP219 meter capex, GBP23.8 ARPM. Central: 72% EBITDA, 35% maintenance capex, 15-year tenure, 6.5-year payback.	CARMA What it does. Canadian suite-level metering and billing platform helping owners and managers allocate utilities, provide consumption visibility, and administer resident accounts. Economic model. Unit: contracted metered suite. Devices, data, billing, and move workflows deter switching; property decisions or service failures cause churn. Capital funds meters, communications, IT, and reinstallation. Evidence bridge. 135,000-plus units in 1,000-plus buildings across four provinces; long-term inflation-protected contracts and 11 million-plus daily reads. Revenue, EBITDA, capex, and churn are unavailable. Central: 9% growth, 33% EBITDA, 12-year tenure, 4.5-year payback; mostly Low-Medium confidence.

KEY DILIGENCE QUESTIONS

Obtain clean metering-segment financials for Energy Assets and CARMA; both materially widen the observed range but have the weakest disclosure. | Separate rollout and acquisition capex from true estate replacement at Smart Metering Systems and Calisen, including communications refresh and removal or reinstallation costs. | Confirm standard contract terms, renewal cohorts, and churn for ista and Techem; legal terms are inferred even though the retention mechanism is well supported. | Test whether digitalization capex currently described as growth is economically required to preserve existing billing and data revenue.

Liquid Environmental Services Operating Benchmark

Two-page benchmark brief | Analysis date: July 18, 2026 | Restaurant Technologies, Liquid Environmental Solutions, Waste Resources Management, and Wind River Environmental

SUBVERTICAL THESIS

The universe contains two structurally different models that should not be averaged. Restaurant Technologies represents an installed onsite-system model: customer-site oil equipment anchors a recurring fresh-oil, service, monitoring, and used-oil recovery relationship. LES, WRM, and Wind River represent route, collection, treatment, and processing: shared trucks, dense routes, permits, disposal access, and treatment throughput drive returns. Onsite embedding supports longer legal terms and customer payback but brings product and installation complexity. Route-processing offers quicker incremental-customer payback and higher margins when density and owned treatment are strong, but it has greater route, vehicle, and plant utilization exposure.

METRIC	BENCHMARK RANGE	WHY THE ASSERTION MAKES SENSE	STRONGEST SUPPORT / CAVEAT
Revenue growth	Onsite system: 5% / 8% / 12% low-central-high. Route-processing: 6% / 9% / 13%.	Onsite growth comes from installed kitchens, chain wins, throughput, and price after removing commodity pass-through. Route growth reflects density, cross-sell, treatment throughput, and new accounts after excluding acquisitions.	RTI serves 45,000-plus kitchens through 41 depots but has no organic/commodity bridge. LES reaches 129,500 locations and 95 facility or partner sites; WRM and Wind River are active acquirers. Confidence: Onsite: Medium; route-processing: Medium
EBITDA margin	Onsite system: 18% / 21% / 25%. Route-processing: 22% / 28% / 32%, with an observed 18%-34% company range.	RTI benefits from sticky service and recovered-oil value but bears fresh-oil, installation, depot, and field costs. Route margin rises when dense collection feeds controlled treatment; mixed services or third-party disposal dilute it.	S&P supported ratings-adjusted EBITDA margins above 30% for LES, the cleanest disclosed route processor. RTI has no current standalone margin; Wind River's plumbing, residential, and specialty-service mix supports a lower 18%-26% company range. Confidence: Onsite: Medium-Low; route-processing: Medium-High
Maintenance capex / revenue	Onsite system: 2.5% / 3.5% / 4.5%. Route-processing: 3.5% / 5.0% / 6.5%.	RTI sustains installed tanks, pumps, filtration, monitoring, and vehicles; new installs are growth capex. Route processors replace vacuum trucks and maintain treatment, environmental, and safety systems.	RTI has 41 depots and 45,000-plus sites; LES reports 670 field vehicles; Wind River reports 1,000 vehicles and 16 plants. None discloses maintenance capex, so ranges use replacement cycles and asset intensity. Confidence: Onsite: Low; route-processing: Medium-Low
Post-maintenance capex conversion	Onsite system: 75% / 83% / 90%. Route-processing: 77% / 82% / 89%.	Both models convert recurring EBITDA well before financing, working capital, and growth capex. RTI maintains distributed equipment; route operators reserve cash for fleet and plants, with mixed platforms weakest.	The ranges are derived as (EBITDA - maintenance capex) / EBITDA. Company central cases are RTI 83%, LES 87%, WRM 83%, and Wind River 75%. S&P's RTI cash-burn commentary shows why this metric is not full equity cash flow. Confidence: Low-Medium for both archetypes because maintenance capex is inferred
Initial contract tenor	Onsite system: 3 / 4 / 5 years. Route-processing: 1 / 2 / 3 years, with an observed 0.5-3-year company range.	RTI likely needs a multi-year term to underwrite onsite equipment. Route service uses shorter commercial agreements, schedules, or callout relationships; renewal behavior matters more than lease-like lockup.	No company publishes a standard term. RTI emphasizes flexibility, not duration; LES and WRM describe recurring services, while Wind River's residential/local mix supports shorter arrangements. Confidence: Low for both archetypes; this is the report's lowest-confidence metric
Effective customer tenure	Onsite system: 6 / 9 / 12 years. Route-processing: 5 / 7 / 10 years.	Equipment, workflow, safety value, and the nuisance of manual oil handling make RTI sticky. Route customers stay because service recurs and reliability, compliance, and local disposal access matter, though switching is easier.	RTI has equipment embedded in more than 45,000 commercial kitchens. LES serves 129,500 locations; WRM bundles grease and adjacent services; Wind River retains trusted local brands across a 75-plus-year operating legacy. Cohort churn is not disclosed. Confidence: Medium for both archetypes
Utilization exposure	Onsite system: Moderate / Moderate / Moderate. Route-processing: Moderate / Moderate-High / High.	RTI equipment can remain deployed while oil throughput softens, so gallons per kitchen and depot density matter. Routes are more exposed to stops, gallons per haul, truck/technician productivity, and plant throughput.	RTI combines 45,000-plus installed kitchens with 41 depots. LES has 670 field vehicles; Wind River has 1,000 vehicles and plants processing more than 200 million gallons annually. Public route-fill and permitted-capacity utilization KPIs are unavailable. Confidence: Medium on classification; Low on exact KPI levels
New-unit / customer payback	Onsite system: 1.5 / 2.5 / 3.5 years. Route-processing: 0.5 / 1.25 / 2.25 years for an incremental customer in an existing dense market.	RTI recovers hardware, installation, acquisition, and route support from whole-relationship contribution. Nearby route customers leverage shared trucks and plants; de novo branches and acquisitions take longer.	RTI cites \$250 and nine labor hours of weekly customer savings, not unit contribution. LES, WRM, and Wind River share fleets and plants; the benchmark does not allocate a whole asset to one account. Confidence: Onsite: Low-Medium; route-processing: Medium-Low
B2B vs B2C	Onsite system: predominantly B2B across low-central-high. Route-processing: predominantly B2B / predominantly B2B / mixed B2B-B2C.	RTI sells to commercial kitchens and institutions. LES and most WRM customers are commercial or industrial. Wind River materially serves households alongside business, municipal, and industrial accounts, widening the route archetype's customer mix.	About 60% of RTI revenue was QSR-related in 2022. LES targets commercial/industrial generators; WRM names commercial/institutional users; Wind River serves homes, businesses, municipalities, and industry. Confidence: High

HOW TO READ THE UNIVERSE

The companies solve recurring, essential oil and wastewater problems, but the bottleneck asset differs. At RTI it is the installed customer-site system and oil workflow. In route-processing it is local density plus permitted treatment or disposal access. That difference drives margin, payback, legal term, and utilization.

Restaurant Technologies

What it does. Installs automated cooking-oil systems and provides fresh-oil delivery, filtration, monitoring, used-oil removal, and recycling, solving kitchen labor, safety, quality, and disposal problems.

Economic model. Unit: installed location; gallons measure usage and depot routes service capacity. Revenue mixes product, service, equipment, and recovery value. Equipment/workflow embedding retains customers; closures, operator changes, low throughput, service failures, or repricing cause churn. Capital funds onsite systems, vehicles, and depots.

Evidence bridge. 45,000-plus kitchens, 41 depots, 1,200-plus employees; about 60% of 2022 revenue was QSR-related. Margin, capex, terms, and payback are derived; S&P reported 2024 cash deficits despite durable revenue.

Liquid Environmental Solutions

What it does. Collects, transports, treats, recycles, and disposes of grease, used oil, wastewater, grit, and related streams for commercial/industrial customers needing recurring sanitation and compliance.

Economic model. Units: route customer for payback, truck/route for utilization, treatment plant for margin. Revenue mixes service, hauling, treatment/disposal, and recovery value. Plants and permits capture spread; recurring need, reliability, and processing access retain accounts. Poor service, pricing, dense rivals, or partner dependence create churn/margin risk.

Evidence bridge. 1,020 employees, 670 vehicles, 95 facility/partner sites, 129,500 locations; earlier 24 plants and 300-plus vacuum trucks. S&P supports margins above 30%. Owned/partner mix, organic growth, churn, and maintenance capex are unavailable.

Waste Resources Management

What it does. Grease-centered platform collecting, processing, transporting, and recycling liquid waste while cross-selling jetting, trap repair, plumbing, septic, sludge, and remediation to commercial/institutional sites.

Economic model. Unit: route customer linked to shared processing. Revenue mixes collection, treatment, recovery, transport, and field work. Vertical integration and bundled reliability retain accounts; switching remains easier than onsite equipment. Capital includes vacuum trucks, specialty units, pumps, tanks, and processing assets.

Evidence bridge. 10,000-plus clients, four states, 300-plus employees; a 2026 deal adds 13 metros. Mixed McDonald Farms services reduce purity. Central: 10% growth, 26% EBITDA, 4.5% maintenance capex, six-year tenure, 1.25-year incremental payback; capex confidence Low.

Wind River Environmental

What it does. East Coast consolidator spanning residential septic, commercial grease, plumbing/drains, municipal-industrial wastewater, specialty services, and treatment management, solving backup, compliance, and downtime risks.

Economic model. Unit: route/service customer; plants drive network margin. Revenue mixes routes, septic cycles, emergencies, and projects. Local trust, recurring need, disposal access, and response retain customers; service inconsistency, competition, and integration cause churn. Its varied fleet/plants create density but heavy maintenance and mixed-business exposure.

Evidence bridge. 1,100-plus experts, 1,000 vehicles, 100 teams, 16 states, 90-plus acquisitions, 16 plants processing 200 million-plus gallons. Central: 9% growth, 22% EBITDA, 5.5% maintenance capex, eight-year tenure, 1.5-year incremental payback. Only clearly mixed B2B-B2C company.

KEY DILIGENCE QUESTIONS

Obtain current standalone revenue and EBITDA for all four private companies and separate organic growth from acquisitions at LES, WRM, and Wind River. | Confirm contract forms, renewal mechanics, and cohort churn. Initial legal tenor is the lowest-confidence conclusion in the report. | Build maintenance capex by asset class: RTI onsite systems and service vehicles; route-company vacuum trucks, tanks, pumps, plants, and environmental and safety capital. | Clarify recovered-material accounting and commodity pass-through: fresh and used oil at RTI; internal treatment, partner routing, and recovery spreads at LES; recovered outputs at WRM and Wind River. | Preserve the payback distinction between an installed RTI location, an incremental dense-route customer, and a full new branch, plant, or acquisition.

Transportation Solutions Operating Benchmark

Two-page source brief | Four structurally distinct archetypes | Analysis date: July 18, 2026

SUBVERTICAL THESIS

Transportation Solutions is not a single benchmark. The report separates railcar leasing, locomotive leasing, airport ground-support-equipment (GSE) full-service leasing, and outsourced yard logistics because asset life, service intensity, contract structure, utilization and capital recovery differ structurally. Rail lessors earn high margins on scarce, long-lived assets but reinvest materially and recover capital over many years. Airport GSE combines rental with maintenance, spare fleets and airport-specific deployment, lowering margins and conversion. Lazer is labor-led outsourced operations, not an asset lessor: margins are lower, sustaining capex and payback are much lighter, and service-capacity utilization dominates. Only the mission-critical, predominantly B2B customer profile carries cleanly across all four.

METRIC	BENCHMARK RANGE	WHY THE ASSERTION MAKES SENSE	STRONGEST SUPPORT / CAVEAT
Revenue growth	Railcar 1% / 4% / 7%; Loco 3% / 6% / 10%; GSE 5% / 8% / 12%; Yard 4% / 7% / 11%.	Railcar growth is price, fleet additions and utilization; locomotives add modernization demand. GSE gains from outsourcing and electrification. Yard growth is new sites and cross-sell.	VTG reported strong tank-wagon but weaker intermodal utilization; Akiem has placed major orders and completed a EUR1.52 billion green refinancing; Air Rail and TCR disclosed expanding fleets; Lazer serves 550+ sites. Confidence: Medium; normalized and triangulated, with private-company segment disclosure limiting precision.
EBITDA margin	Railcar 52% / 58% / 65%; Loco 55% / 62% / 70%; GSE 24% / 30% / 36% (observed 20%-38%); Yard 10% / 14% / 18%.	Rail earns high lease spreads, tempered by maintenance and off-lease drag. GSE bears technician and workshop cost. Yard payroll and shift efficiency cap margins.	Akiem's official 2021 transaction data showed roughly EUR150 million EBITDA on EUR220 million revenue. TCR runs 100+ workshops and about 1,000 technicians. Lazer reports 5,000 employees and 9 million annual service hours. Confidence: Medium; Air Rail's 20% / 27% / 33% range is Low due to mixed, private reporting.
Maintenance capex / revenue	Railcar 14% / 18% / 24%; Loco 12% / 18% / 25%; GSE 10% / 14% / 18%; Yard 2% / 4% / 7%.	Wagons need overhaul and replacement; locomotives add ERTMS and compliance work. GSE needs refurbishment and batteries. Yard sustains tractors and tech only.	VTG spent EUR536 million on fixed assets in 2024, mainly new wagons and fleet maintenance. Akiem is upgrading about 250 locomotives for ERTMS. Air Rail and TCR explicitly provide full lifecycle maintenance and refurbishment. Confidence: Medium overall; exact private-company gross sustaining spend is the report's lowest-confidence area.
Post-maintenance capex conversion	Railcar 54% / 69% / 78%; Loco 55% / 71% / 83%; GSE 40% / 55% / 67% (observed 35%-69%); Yard 55% / 71% / 84%.	The measure is (EBITDA minus maintenance capex) / EBITDA, not full free cash flow. Rail and GSE margins are high, but sustaining fleet spend absorbs cash; Lazer's lower margin is offset by a much lighter physical-capital burden.	Ranges are calculated directly from each archetype's normalized EBITDA and maintenance-capex assumptions and exclude interest, taxes, working capital, lease principal and growth capex. Confidence: Medium; derived, with sensitivity to the growth-versus-sustaining capex split.
Initial contract tenor	Railcar 2 / 4 / 7 years; Loco 5 / 7 / 10; GSE 3 / 5 / 7; Yard 1 / 3 / 5.	High unit value and approvals require longer locomotive terms. Wagon and GSE packages are medium term. Yard mobilization needs less legal duration than large assets.	VTG materials describe medium-to-long-term wagon hire; Akiem supports rolling stock through handback; TCR is described as having long-term contractual relationships. Lazer is embedded operationally but replaceable at rebid. Confidence: Medium; largely inferred because weighted-average contract terms are not publicly disclosed.
Effective customer tenure	Railcar 6 / 9 / 12 years; Loco 8 / 12 / 15; GSE 6 / 9 / 13 (observed 5-14); Yard 4 / 7 / 10.	Customer life outlasts one asset or site contract. Industrial wagon pools, approved locomotive fleets, multi-airport placements and deeply integrated yard staffing are resized, renewed or refreshed without changing provider.	The report cites fleet integration in industrial flows, Akiem's framework and lifecycle support, TCR's long-term relationships, and Lazer customer testimony about embedded operating performance. Confidence: Medium; tenure is inferred from integration, not disclosed churn cohorts.
Utilization exposure	Railcar Moderate / Moderate / High; Loco Moderate / Moderate / High; GSE Moderate / Moderate-to-High / High; Yard High / High / High.	Rail depends on paid deployment and redeployment; locomotive downtime is concentrated. GSE adds ramp use and spare fleets. Yard depends on productive labor hours.	VTG's intermodal utilization weakened while tank wagons stayed high. TCR discusses idle-fleet waste and telematics right-sizing. Lazer's 9 million annual service hours make service-capacity utilization the decisive KPI. Confidence: Medium for asset models; High for Lazer's classification.
New-unit / customer payback	Railcar 7 / 9 / 12 years; Loco 8 / 10 / 13; GSE 4 / 5.5 / 7.5; Yard 0.8 / 1.5 / 2.5.	Rail needs multiple placements and residual value. GSE is cheaper but service-heavy. Yard launch spend is mainly recruiting, training, limited equipment and tech.	All ranges are triangulated from fully burdened investment and unit- or site-level cash contribution after direct cost and a maintenance reserve; none uses revenue payback alone. Confidence: Medium; Air Rail's company-specific payback is Low confidence because segment financials are thin.
B2B versus B2C	Railcar, Loco, GSE and Yard: predominantly B2B; Loco includes public-authority exposure.	Customers buy capital relief, uptime, compliance and outsourcing. Contracts sit with operators, authorities, airports, handlers, industrial firms and 3PLs.	Each company's official customer description is institutional; the report found no economically relevant direct B2C revenue stream in the benchmarked segments. Confidence: High.

HOW TO READ THE UNIVERSE

Five businesses map to four models: VTG is the railcar reference; Akiem is a mixed leasing-plus-maintenance locomotive platform; TCR is the core airport-GSE reference and Air Rail a smaller mixed airport/rail reference; Lazer is a separate outsourced-operations archetype. The economic unit shifts from one earning wagon or locomotive, to a GSE station package, to a yard-site contract and service hour.

VTG

What it does. Leases and manages European freight wagons for industrial shippers and rail operators.

Economic model. Unit: earning wagon; revenue: recurring lease plus services. Customers avoid capital and secure compliant, cargo-specific capacity. VTG maintains and redeploys fleets; integration retains customers, while lane loss and intermodal weakness create churn. Long life and residuals offset heavy sustaining work.

Evidence bridge. 2024: EUR405m operating cash flow and EUR536m fixed-asset investment, mainly new wagons and maintenance; tank utilization stayed high while intermodal softened.

Akiem

What it does. Leases and maintains locomotives and some passenger rolling stock across Europe.

Economic model. Unit: locomotive under lease/full service. Operators outsource scarce, compliant traction. Akiem runs workshops, overhauls and upgrades; approvals and uptime support retention, while concession loss or technical mismatch cause churn. Long contracts, residuals and repeat placements fund heavy capital needs.

Evidence bridge. 2021: 600+ locomotives, 46 passenger trains, about EUR220m revenue and EUR150m EBITDA. A EUR1.52bn 2026 refinancing supports growth; about 250 locomotives are receiving ERTMS.

Air Rail

What it does. AIR RAIL, S.L. leases, maintains and refurbishes airport GSE; it also has rail activities.

Economic model. Unit: deployed GSE/station package. Rental, maintenance, parts and resale solve airline/handler capex and uptime needs. Airport service embeds relationships; rebids and transfer friction cause churn. Fleets, batteries and charging drive capital needs.

Evidence bridge. IFM owns 75%. March 2026: 4,700+ units, about 60 airports, eight countries and 68% of motorized units electric. Identity is High confidence; segment metrics are lower confidence.

TCR

What it does. Rents, maintains, refurbishes and electrifies GSE for airlines, handlers and airports.

Economic model. Unit: GSE/airport fleet package. Full-service rent and lifecycle services solve turnaround uptime and capital needs. Workshops, technicians and spares embed TCR; handler rebids drive churn. Scale aids utilization but requires renewal and reserve fleet.

Evidence bridge. 44,000+ assets, 100+ workshops, 1,800+ employees, 24 countries and 200+ airports. GIP's March 2026 acquisition agreement was expected to close in Q3.

Lazer Logistics

What it does. Runs warehouse and industrial yards using drivers, equipment, processes and technology.

Economic model. Unit: site contract/service hour. Recurring site and labor revenue solves trailer-flow bottlenecks. Lazer staffs and supervises yards; integration supports retention, while rebids, closures and volume loss cause churn. Labor utilization dominates limited equipment capital.

Evidence bridge. EQT reports 550+ sites, 5,000 employees, 6,000 fleet assets and 9m annual service hours. Lazer is outsourced operations, not an asset-leasing benchmark.

KEY DILIGENCE QUESTIONS

Do not blend the four archetypes: the asset-owner versus labor-operator distinction drives margins, capex, utilization and payback. | Private-company maintenance capex is the weakest metric; obtain gross replacement, refurbishment, battery/electrification and growth-fleet splits. | Measure paid utilization by asset family, off-lease days and redeployment cost rather than relying on headline fleet counts. | Separate legal term from customer life and isolate airport-, lane- or site-level churn from whole-account retention. | Air Rail's legal identity is resolved, but its airport GSE segment remains mixed with rail activities; TCR's ownership was signed but not closed at the analysis date.

Specialty Rental Operating Benchmark

Two-page source brief | Four operating archetypes | Analysis date: July 18, 2026

SUBVERTICAL THESIS

Specialty rental splits into four economically distinct models: consumer-led delivered portable storage, B2B portable/mobile storage, modular space and temporary classrooms/offices, and trench-safety equipment. A narrow combined central envelope - about 5% growth, 34% EBITDA margin, 7% maintenance capex, 79% post-maintenance conversion and 4.8-year payback - is directionally useful but inferior to the archetype ranges. Standard B2B containers have the cleanest recurring rent, longest asset lives and strongest cash conversion. Modular units stay installed longer but cost more to deliver and refurbish. Trench safety is short-duration and project-sensitive but safety-critical. PODS overlays consumer acquisition, moving logistics, routes and yards. Reliant Rental remains unresolved and is excluded from benchmark weighting.

METRIC	BENCHMARK RANGE	WHY THE ASSERTION MAKES SENSE	STRONGEST SUPPORT / CAVEAT
Revenue growth	Consumer storage 1% / 4% / 7%; B2B storage 2% / 5% / 8%; Modular 3% / 6% / 9%; Trench 3% / 6% / 10%.	Growth is rate, units on rent and fleet additions: home moves for PODS, local availability for containers, project pipelines for modular and utility work for trench.	Mobile Mini's 2019 Storage Solutions rental revenue grew 4.0% and yield 3.5%; Modulaire reported more units on rent and 5% revenue-per-unit growth in 1Q22; TPRC had reached 37 branches and 5,000+ customers by 2021. Confidence: High for B2B storage and modular; Medium for trench safety; Low for consumer storage.
EBITDA margin	Consumer storage 28% / 33% / 38%; B2B storage 33% / 40% / 44%; Modular 28% / 34% / 38%; Trench 28% / 33% / 38%.	Simple steel containers maximize margin. Modular adds installation; trench adds branch, engineering and hauling cost; PODS bears delivery, yards and linehaul.	Mobile Mini disclosed a 41.0% Storage Solutions adjusted EBITDA margin in 2019. Modulaire reported EUR116 million EBITDA on EUR370 million revenue in 1Q22, just over 31%. PODS showed operating leverage when Q3 2024 sales fell 7.5% and EBITDA fell 24%. Confidence: High for B2B storage and modular; Medium for trench; Low for PODS.
Maintenance capex / revenue	Consumer storage 5% / 7% / 9%; B2B storage 4% / 6% / 8%; Modular 6% / 8% / 11%; Trench 5% / 7% / 10%.	Containers have long lives and high residuals; PODS also sustains delivery equipment, yards and systems. Modular requires refurbishment and resets. Trench fleets need inspection, repair, replacement and handling gear despite durable steel assets.	Mobile Mini assets had 30-year lives and 55% residuals. McGrath uses 18 years/50% for modular and 25 years/62.5% for storage. Ranges are inferred from replacement cycles. Confidence: Medium except Low for PODS; gross-versus-net replacement remains an important diligence gap.
Post-maintenance capex conversion	Consumer storage 68% / 79% / 87%; B2B storage 76% / 85% / 91%; Modular 61% / 76% / 84%; Trench 64% / 79% / 87%.	The calculation is (EBITDA minus maintenance capex) / EBITDA, before interest, tax, working capital and growth capex. B2B containers convert best because margins are high and sustaining fleet needs modest; modular gives up more cash to refurbishment.	Every range is calculated from the report's normalized margin and maintenance-capex assumptions rather than reported free cash flow. Confidence: Medium; Low for PODS because both input assumptions are lower-confidence.
Initial contract tenor	Consumer storage 1 / 1 / 3 months; B2B storage 1 / 3 / 12 months; Modular 12 / 18 / 36 months; Trench 1 week / 2 months / 6 months.	Consumer moves and trench phases need flexibility; commercial containers are month-based but extend. Installed modular space stays through school years or project phases, creating the longest initial terms.	PODS markets flexible monthly use; Mobile Mini used month-based rentals; McGrath states 1-12 months for storage and 12-24 months for modular; General Finance reported a typical lease averaging more than 12 months. Confidence: High for modular; Medium for the other archetypes.
Effective customer tenure	Consumer storage 3 / 8 / 18 months; B2B storage 2 / 4 / 7 years; Modular 4 / 7 / 10 years; Trench 3 / 5 / 8 years.	PODS tenure ends with the move or renovation. Commercial contractors, schools, institutions and utilities return across projects, so customer life materially exceeds any one unit's rental duration.	Mobile Mini served about 74,000 customers with low concentration; Modulaire serves 52,000+ customers; TPRC served 5,000+ customers. The report infers relationship tenure from repeat-account structures rather than disclosed churn cohorts. Confidence: Medium except Low for PODS.
Utilization exposure	Consumer storage Moderate / Moderate-to-High / High; B2B storage Moderate / Moderate / High; Modular Moderate / Moderate / Moderate-to-High; Trench Moderate-to-High / High / High.	Idle fleet earns no rent. Containers redeploy readily; modular units face installation and removal friction; trench inventory rolls off with project completion. PODS adds route and yard utilization to loaded-container exposure.	Mobile Mini's 2019 utilization was 79.1% by units and 77.9% by original cost; Modulaire reported 86% in 1Q22; McGrath's 2025 utilization was 73.0% for Mobile Modular and 60.8% for Portable Storage. Confidence: High for B2B storage and modular; Medium for trench; Low for PODS.
New-unit / customer payback	Consumer storage 2.5 / 3.5 / 5.0 years; B2B storage 3.5 / 4.5 / 6.0; Modular 4.5 / 6.0 / 8.0; Trench 2.5 / 3.5 / 5.0.	Cash payback reserves delivery, service and maintenance. Containers and trench steel have residual value; modular costs more; PODS needs rent plus move-event profit.	General Finance said revenue could recover original equipment cost within four years, but the report extends cash payback after direct costs. McGrath storage rents at 2%-4% of original cost monthly; long lives and residuals support downside value. Confidence: Medium; Low for PODS. All ranges are triangulated rather than direct cash-payback disclosures.
B2B versus B2C	Consumer storage Mixed / Mixed leaning B2C / Mixed; B2B storage, Modular and Trench: predominantly B2B.	PODS materially serves households whose event-driven demand creates shorter tenure and more acquisition cost. Other archetypes contract mainly with contractors, commercial and industrial users, schools, government, institutions and utilities.	Company disclosures identify PODS as residential and commercial; Mobile Mini's account structure was commercial; Modulaire and McGrath emphasize institutional/enterprise markets; TPRC served contractors and utilities. Confidence: High for the three B2B archetypes; Medium for PODS's exact mix.

HOW TO READ THE UNIVERSE

Seven designated names yield four usable archetypes. Mobile Mini is the clearest B2B storage reference; Modulaire and McGrath support modular; TPRC anchors trench safety; PODS is the consumer-led delivered-storage exception. General Finance bridges storage and modular but has mixed assets and sales. Reliant Rental is an identity exception, not a benchmark input. Acquired companies use their last reliable standalone periods.

PODS

What it does. Delivers containers for residential and commercial moving/storage.
Economic model. Unit: container-month plus move event; revenue is rent and logistics fees. Customers solve moves or renovations. PODS runs drivers, yards and linehaul; life-event completion causes churn. Container and delivery assets require capital.
Evidence bridge. 2m+ long-distance moves and 7m+ deliveries. Q3 2024 sales fell 7.5%, EBITDA 24%; ranges are Low confidence.

Mobile Mini

What it does. Rented storage containers and ground-level offices to commercial users.
Economic model. Unit: box on rent; revenue was mostly rental. Branches deliver and refurbish simple assets solving temporary jobsite needs. Projects end placements, but accounts repeat. Long lives and residuals limit capital needs.
Evidence bridge. 2019 standalone: \$490.7m Storage revenue, 41.0% margin, 79.1% unit utilization; assets had 30-year lives and 55% residuals.

Trench Plate Rental

What it does. Rented trench plates, shoring and safety systems to contractors and utilities.
Economic model. Unit: jobsite equipment set; revenue is rental/support. Branches solve mandatory excavation safety, then inspect and redeploy steel. Projects end rentals, but contractors repeat. Residual value helps capital recovery; project timing drives utilization.
Evidence bridge. Pre-2021 merger: 37 branches and 5,000+ customers. Financial ranges are Medium-confidence triangulations.

General Finance Corporation

What it does. Rented containers, mobile offices and modular units through regional brands.
Economic model. Unit: fleet asset; revenue is lease plus sales. Customers need temporary space. GFC delivered, maintained and re-leased units; projects cause churn, while accounts repeat. Long lives/residuals support capital recovery; mixed assets dilute margins.
Evidence bridge. FY2020: \$164.7m North America and \$63.1m Asia-Pacific leasing revenue; 70%-85% utilization, 20-30-year lives, residuals up to 70%.

Modulaire Group

What it does. Rents and installs modular space for public, infrastructure and enterprise users.
Economic model. Unit: module on rent; revenue is lease/service. Customers need temporary space. Modulaire transports, installs and refurbishes units; installation and repeat projects support retention. Resets and yards raise capital needs versus containers.
Evidence bridge. 330,000 units, 52,000+ customers. 1Q22: EUR370m revenue, EUR116m EBITDA, 86% utilization; capex precision is weaker.

McGrath RentCorp

What it does. Rents modular buildings and storage containers to businesses and institutions.
Economic model. Unit: module/container; revenue is rent plus delivery/service. Customers need classrooms, jobsite space or storage. McGrath installs and refurbishes; repeat accounts outlast placements. Strong residuals limit replacement, though modular resets consume capital.
Evidence bridge. 2025: modular utilization 73.0%, storage 60.8%. Lives/residuals: modular 18 years/50%; storage 25 years/62.5%.

Reliant Rental

What it does. No standalone specialty-rental operator is resolved; evidence points only to a Vander/BlueLine brand candidate.
Economic model. Unavailable: no supported asset, unit, revenue, customer, operating, capital or churn model. BlueLine economics cannot be substituted.
Evidence bridge. A 2014 trademark links Reliant to Vander; BlueLine sold in 2018. All metrics are Unavailable, Low confidence and unweighted.

KEY DILIGENCE QUESTIONS

Keep the four archetypes separate: asset standardization and service intensity are the largest sources of economic variation. | Use gross replacement and refurbishment requirements, not depreciation or net capex alone, to assess sustaining capital. | Track physical and dollar utilization with consistent denominators; delivery, yard and branch utilization can matter as much as units on rent. | Separate unit rental duration from repeat-account life; short monthly or job-phase contracts can coexist with multi-year customer tenure. | Resolve Reliant Rental's exact legal and operating identity before assigning any metric or including it in a benchmark.